

and mobile companies for whom gaming is now an important revenue stream. The developer community is evolving and gaining maturity, many companies are still young, they have much to learn and it will take time to hit international quality benchmarks. Dhruva was lucky to have international exposure right from the beginning. We are working with six of the top ten publishers and have contributed to the development of over 30 AAA blockbuster console & PC games.” About the technology that Dhruva uses in games, he said, “We usually use a DX version between DX7 and DX9 for our target spec, because the mass market consumer in India is primarily using fairly low-end systems and a version of Windows between 98 and XP.” We also asked about the games they create, whether it is for the Indian audience or the Global audience and he said, “We keep both markets in mind when developing games, but our primary source of revenue has come from the international markets.”

When it comes to education, there is definitely a limitation in India with most students looking for an MBA or not even knowing that the option for Game Programming or Game Designing exist after their degrees in engineering. We got in touch with Divij Durvey from Mumbai, who is now studying a Game Programming and Designing related course at Pace University in New York and had this to say, “I have always been a gamer and since I was studying engineering I wanted to pursue it further. When I spoke about my plans to my professors at college, they really didn’t have any advice for me, which lead me to look for a course abroad.” SAGE, the School of Advanced Graphics and Engineering, is an

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institute where they teach you games programming. SAGE is run by Mr. Priyadarshi Chowdhary, who is the Founder and CEO. We asked him about the courses offered at SAGE and he replied, “We teach only Games Programming and we also have an advanced course where we teach students how to create their own Game Engines. We normally teach students on the OGRE engine.” On their web site, www.sageinfoabs.com, it is mentioned that SAGE has also started a course that teaches console game programming for the Xbox 360. Mr. Priyadarshi says, “We have started the course for console game programming, but people prefer to enroll for PC game programming.” About getting a job in this line he said, “There is a lot of scope and we also have a placement program.” Mr. Anthony Withaker of RZ2 Games said, “We hold many workshops, sponsorship programs and events for colleges like IIT. We have an internship program going on where we currently have three students with us also.” Mr. Sashi Reddi of FXLabs Studios said, “One of our main aim is to nurture budding talent around this industry. We have been running FX – Learning Academy, where in we get freshers on board and give them immense training around game programming and Art side before starting their actual work with us.”

Here is some advice Mr. Sashi Reddi has given to young adults who wish to pursue a career in this field, “For students who want to get into gaming it is important to understand what is it that they aspire to do in this field. If they are interested in programming games, they should learn programming languages like C, C++ and be strong at Maths and Physics. For people who would like to animate characters or make assets for games like vehicles, buildings, etc they should learn 3D editing software like 3Dmax and Maya. Students who are interested in designing a game should play a lot of games, understand the different genres of games, possess good analytical skills and be very creative at coming up with ideas for games that would keep people engaged. Best way to start a career in game design is to start writing reviews and walkthroughs for the games you are currently playing.”

We definitely know that this industry is going to grow stronger but currently it is moving at a slow pace as in comparison to other countries and from the looks of it India’s Game Developers are catering more towards the casuals games meant for the Indian audience. We still have hope that the day will come when India will be the hub for all Game Development with host to all types of gamers.■



The SAGE studios, where young minds of the country learn Game Programming.

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